

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This book was made possible only via the generosity, shared insights, and outright assistance of so many people.^{[461](#)}

Morgan Housel (of *The Psychology of Money* fame) and Craig Pearce (Harriman House) gently prodded me over the past few years to write this particular book. They both insisted it would be a fast and easy review of all of my previous ideas, commentaries, and columns. They were mistaken. Thank you for this white lie.

Craig was a delight to work with as an editor: a firm but gentle hand was exactly what this material required. I found the writing joyous and the editing process painless. What more could you ever ask for from a publisher?

A few other editors whose influence can be seen in these pages: Kelly Johnson at *The Washington Post* helped me find my voice speaking to Main Street investors. Thomas Donlan from *Barron's* showed me how to excise all of the fat, leaving only sinew and muscle for readers. Tim O'Brien and David Shipley for bringing me to Bloomberg. Most of all, James Greiff taught me how to weave data with opinion, respect the readers' time, and get to the damned point already. (Jim, I have stopped my throat clearing, except perhaps for the first section in the first part of the book.)

The team at Ritholtz Wealth Management is a perpetual source of ideas, data, context, insight, and wisdom. You see many references to the RWM folk, as they have been a large source of feedback and refinement of my own investing philosophy. This book would have been so much less rich without them. Ben Carlson, Michael Batnick, Josh Brown, Nick Maggiulli, and Callie Cox all deserve a special shout-out. Their voices were echoing in my head as I wrote this. The Tax Bills—Bill Sweet and Bill Artzerounian—were enormously helpful to everything tax-related. Ben, Michael, and Callie, along with the rest of my investment committee, including Taylor